

GOODBYE, RO-KO
The Indian tricolour draped over their shoulders, Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma pose with the World Cup trophy. Both announced their retirement from T20 internationals

ROHIT REPEATEDLY RISKED HIS WICKET FOR RAPID STARTS. KOHLI ADOPTED A BRAND NEW APPROACH. FOR THE WORLD CUP, BOTH PUT THE TEAM'S INTEREST FIRST

anointed India's new T20 captain, whilst both Rohit and Virat found themselves out of the squad for close to 11 months: signs that suggested Indian cricket had decided to invest in youngsters in the game's shortest format. And whilst they did make a last-minute entry into the Indian squad—prompted by Rohit and Virat's form at the ODI World Cup last year—their task was cut out.

ELIMINATING THE FEAR OF FAILURE

At the core of India's plan to wrest back the T20 trophy after 17 years was to eliminate the fear of failure that had crippled them on previous occasions. The pressure of winning a title, plus the tag of being favourites at every major cricket event, did seem to weigh heavy on their shoulders—as was evident from their under-par performances in key matches, whilst being in imperious form during the rest of the tournament. The first step towards sorting this out was to acknowledge that this 'fear of failure' did exist. A phrase hitherto used by experts and media to explain India's fallibility at the final hurdle, never had anyone in the team addressed it. But that changed too. During a media interaction at this World